What You Carry In: The Ownership Argument

Front Matter, Chapter 8/12 — Revision & Viva-Prep Cheatsheet (English + Roman Urdu)
Source: agentfactory.panaversity.org/docs/what-you-carry-in

EN: The model is rented, the runtime changes, the method is given free -- so what can a practitioner actually OWN? An elimination test: 5 refusals leave exactly 1 surviving asset: a profession's governed knowledge, in one jurisdiction -- a vertical System of Record.
Roman Urdu: Model rented hai, runtime badalta hai, method muft diya jata hai -- to practitioner asal mein kya OWN kar sakta hai? Elimination test: 5 refusals se sirf 1 surviving asset bachta hai: ek profession ka governed knowledge, ek jurisdiction mein -- vertical System of Record.

1. Five Refusals (candidates that fail ownership)

- **Model** -- rented, a competitor rents the same one. **Runtime** -- you're trained to stay portable, not to build it. **Your own labour** -- the machine is absorbing hours/syntax. **Vendor's platform** -- their leverage, not yours. **Method** -- the book teaches everyone the same thing, so it's never a differentiator.
- **Ownership test (2 halves):** (a) you hold it, not rented; (b) not everyone holds it -- it differentiates you.

2. The One Surviving Asset

- A profession's governed knowledge, in one jurisdiction = a **vertical System of Record**. 'Yours' is narrow -- the corpus is jointly held (you + the expert).
- **3 durable properties:** doesn't commoditize (needs maintenance, not replacement), can be licensed (judgment becomes a business asset), compounds (every engagement adds an outcome).
- **Reputation** survives the elimination test too -- but it can't be licensed, transferred, or made agent-readable, and it stops compounding the moment you stop working. The asset beats it on durability+transferability+compounding.

3. Two SoRs + Why Narrowing Matters

- A practitioner carries 2 SoRs: **Shared** (the book's method -- same for everyone, no advantage) and **Profession** (built with an expert -- nobody else has it).
- **Why not widen it?** A wide 'generic' container has no source hierarchy, no invariants across professions -- narrowing IS what makes it an asset. Vendor-neutrality doesn't just permit a vertical, it REQUIRES one.

4. Build First, Sell Second

- The slice doesn't wait for a buyer -- it CREATES one. Sequence: expert -> slice -> sponsor -> baseline -> contract -> engagement -> thick.
- **4 gates in order:** expert sign-off -> rights basis written -> (build the slice) -> named sponsor + contract of success -> real supplier prices.

Key Terms Cheatsheet

One line each — English + Roman Urdu.

Term	English	Roman Urdu
5 Refusals	Model, Runtime, Your own labour, Vendor's platform, Method -- none pass the ownership test.	Model, Runtime, Apna labour, Vendor platform, Method -- koi ownership test pass nahi karta.
Vertical System of Record	The one surviving asset: a profession's governed knowledge in one jurisdiction.	Ek surviving asset: profession ka governed knowledge, ek jurisdiction mein.
Thin vs Thick slice	Thin = one outcome fully covered; Thick = many outcomes covered.	Thin = ek outcome poori tarah covered; Thick = kai outcomes covered.
Build first, sell second	A real slice must exist before any sales conversation -- it creates the buyer.	Sales conversation se pehle real slice exist karni chahiye -- yehi buyer paida karta hai.
Contract of success	3 buyer-verifiable numbers: baseline, success-definition, review-method.	3 buyer-verifiable numbers: baseline, success-definition, review-method.

Viva Prep -- Representative Q&A;

Question	Answer
Why doesn't 'the method' (what the book teaches) count as an ownable asset?	It teaches everyone the same thing, so it can never differentiate you from another graduate.
What's the one asset that survives the 5-refusal elimination test?	A vertical System of Record -- a profession's governed knowledge, in one jurisdiction.
Why does Reputation fail to beat the vertical SoR as an asset, even though it also survives elimination?	It can't be licensed, transferred, or made agent-readable, and stops compounding the moment you stop working.
Why does vendor-neutrality REQUIRE a vertical rather than just allow one?	Without a vertical, a 'generic' knowledge container has no source hierarchy or invariants -- narrowing is what makes it an asset at all.
What's the correct sequence: expert, slice, sponsor, baseline, contract, engagement?	Expert -> slice -> sponsor -> baseline -> contract -> engagement -> thick -- the slice always comes before the sales conversation.

Where This Leads / Sources

Leads to: The Roles This Book Trains, FDE AF Model, Choosing Your Vertical, Designing the Vertical SoR, How to Get Paid.

Source: docs/what-you-carry-in/ (this repo), content originally via Zia Tutor AI connector.